

Developing Soft Skills and Personality

Week 5
Module 1
Lecture 25

Technology & Communication

*Dr. T. Ravichandran
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The Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, India*



**Technological
Personality?**

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



More Challenges

Handling difficult callers

Dealing with angry callers

Essential Telephone Skills

Manage your voice

Be an active listener

Be cheerful

Know your caller

Replace fear with confidence

Be Polite

Avoid Jargons

Anticipate Problems

Consider calls as opportunities

You should be the person any body wants to talk to!

Cyborgs: Part Human Part Machine

- Donna Haraway refers to the techno-humans as “cyborgs” in *Simians, Cyborgs, and Women* (1991)
- The boundaries between man and machine are blurred.
- Organisms are no longer bodes of knowledge but biotic components, a kind of information-processing device.
- Cyborgs—cybernetic organisms—a result of a **fusion between biology and technology**
- Cybernetics: the study of control systems.



How We Became Cyborgs?



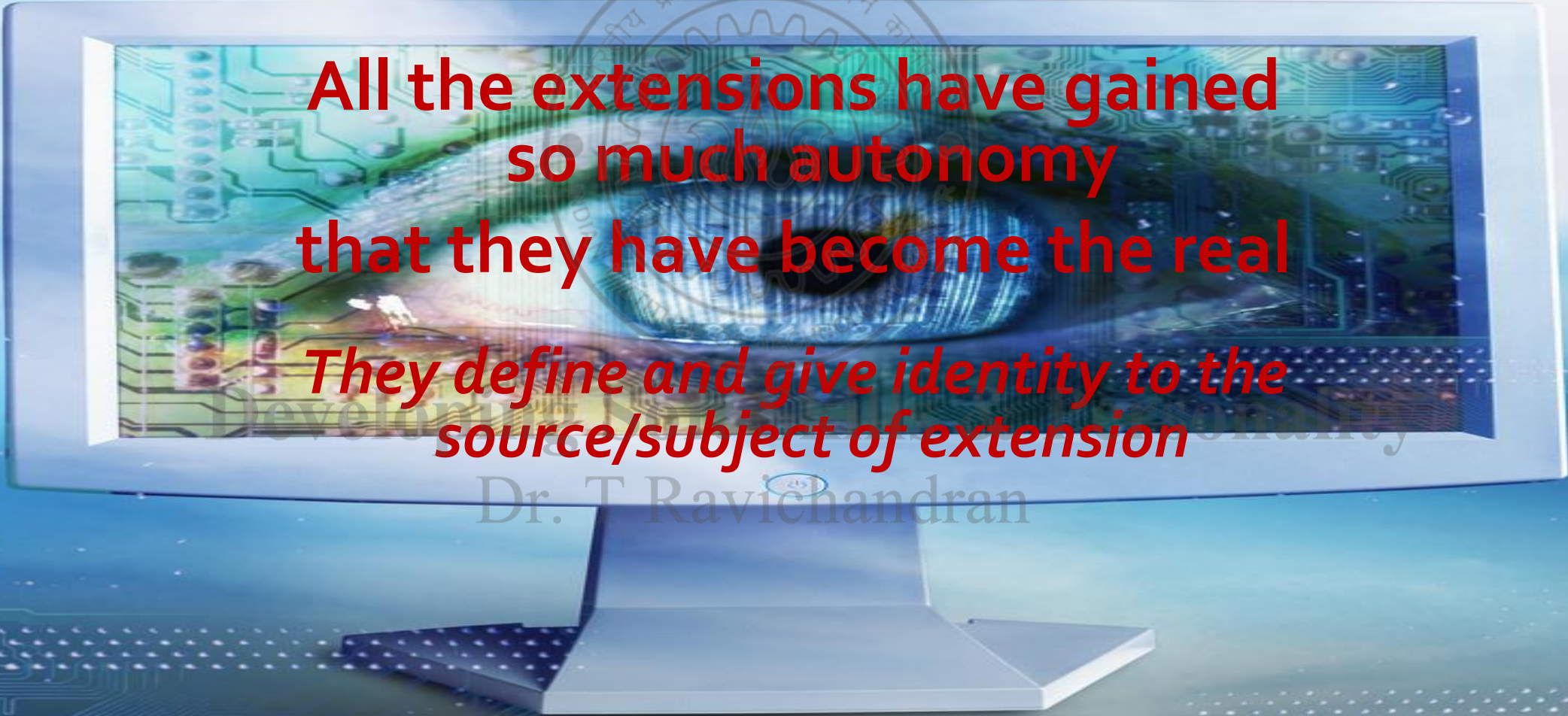
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*"All media are extensions of
some human faculty . . .*

*The wheel is an extension of the foot,
the book is an extension of the eye . . .
clothing, an extension of the skin . . .
electric circuitry,
an extension of the nervous system."*

~ Marshall McLuhan, The Medium is the Message

In Techno/Cyberculture Scenario... the extensions are the real



**All the extensions have gained
so much autonomy
that they have become the real**

***They define and give identity to the
source/subject of extension***

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- Machine is given human treatment and human is treated like a machine
- Story: The father's new car.
- “Our machines are disturbingly lively and we ourselves are frighteningly inert.” ~ Donna Haraway

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The Changing Times: The Cyborgian Shift

Amazing transformation cyberspace/cyberculture

You Tube, Facebook, Twitter, What's app, iPod . . .

The web, the internet, the mobile

New devices, new applications, new technologies, new practices

This affects the Mind and the Body; the thought patterns, thinking capabilities; ways of expression/communication; change in language

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The Mind, the Body @Technology



The “human” today is rarely divorced from technology.

Technology is *within* medical technologies, *beside* telephones, and *outside* satellites. Man inhabits technology when he functions in a climate-controlled office space or technology inhabits man when it functions in him as a pacemaker. When man uses, for instance, a pair of eye-glasses as a prosthetic device, technology seems to be an appendage. Nevertheless, as man works in assembly line, he appears to serve as an appendage.

S. Aronowitz, et al., *Technoscience and Cyberculture*

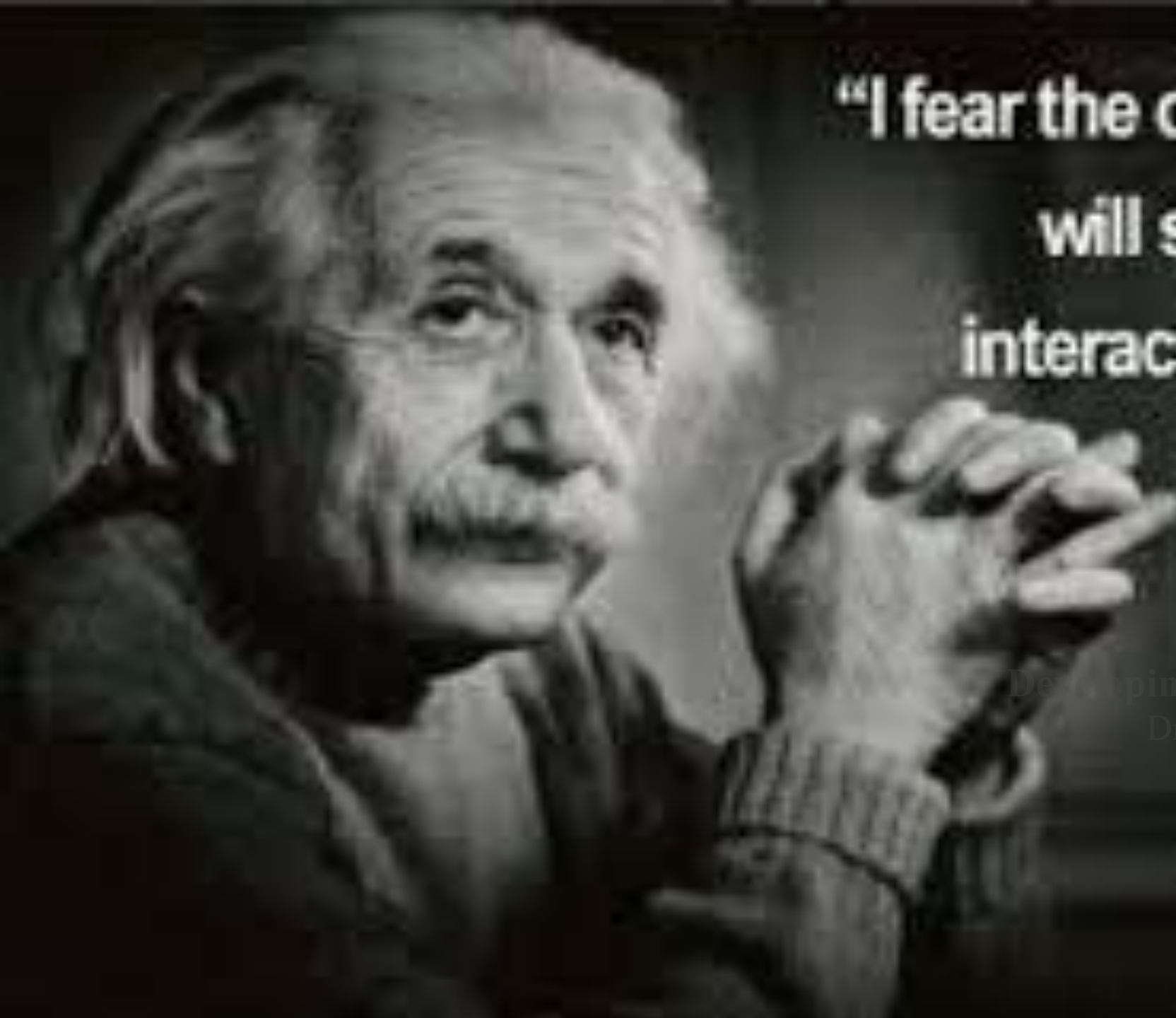
Three Key Words: Control, Benefit, Choice

- Who controls technology?
- Who benefits from it?
- Do we have a choice? Or who is choosing it for us?

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**"I fear the day that technology
will surpass our human
interaction. The world will
have a generation
of idiots."**



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Albert Einstein

**Mobile phones makes you
closer to person far from you,**



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**but it takes u away from the
ones sitting next to you.**

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Week 5
Module 2
Lecture 26

Technology & Communication

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Mobile Personality?

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



Impact and Influence of Technology in Communication

Donna Haraway's "Cyborgs": Cybernetic Organisms

Blurred interface between biotic and mechanical

We became cyborgs by treating all media extensions of human faculty as real.

Technological components define as well as give human identity.

Machine is given human treatment and human is treated like a machine. Story: The father's new car.

The cyborgian shift is affecting the mind and the body.

KEY WORDS: Control, Benefit and Choice

Who controls technology?

Who benefits from it?

Do we have a choice? Or who is choosing it for us?

Mobile/Cell Phone Technology

- The purpose is to give mobility against fixity
- The main intention is to save time
- To help in emergency
- To connect people instantaneously
- To keep human contact intact.
- Cell phones have moved away from their original purpose
- With smartphones, once can check e-mail, play games, chat in social media, listen to songs, watch movies, and send text messages
- The original intention of facilitating communication through voice remotely is forgotten!



Have you become “moborgs”? : Test



- Do you sleep and wake up with your mobile?
- Listen to songs or soothing music or watch movie before sleeping?
- Mobile alarm wakes you up?
- Do you carry mobile with you all the time?
- Do you have some mobile free hours like while walking, praying, playing some sports?
- Have you stopped wearing a wrist watch?
- Do you use only mobile phone to check time?

ng to music from a
music only through y
ing news on the te
s through various
a calculator?

- Using address book/phone book
to store address and phone



Are you a mobile addict?

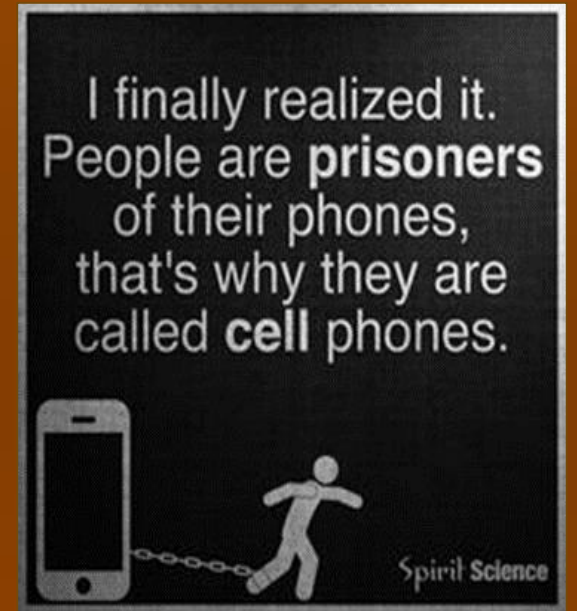


- Before going to bed do you feel insecure if mobile is not kept near your pillow?
- While sleeping, do you get up frequently to check for messages?
- Do you sacrifice your sleep routine due to your interest in activities in mobile? (long chat, playing games, checking Facebook, etc.)
- How long can you live without your mobile? If somebody gives you one crore rupees?

Forever, for 10 years, for 1 year, for some months, for 1 month, for 15 days, for 10 days, for 3 days, for 1 day, for some hours, for some minutes ... CAN'T LIVE WITHOUT A MINUTE! (Nomophobia!)

Are you a mobile addict?

- Do you get nervous when some apps do not work?
- Do you get nightmares about losing your phone?
- Are you afraid that your battery will run down soon?
- Do you keep an additional mobile as a spare?
- Do you get eye strain and neck problems due to texting and excessive use?
- Have you met with a car accident due to mobile use?
- Do you talk on phone while driving your bike?
- Do you miss important activities owing to your preoccupation with mobile? (Obsessive Compulsive Disorder)



Are you a mobile addict?



- Do you panic when you misplace your phone?
- Do you feel stressed if your phone malfunctions, falls into water, slips down and breaks?
- Do you remain highly stressed and not able to focus on other activities till you restore your mobile phone?
- Do you get angry if someone touches your phone, or checks it?
- Can't you resist taking a call even in important meetings?
- Even when you are surrounded by friends, you keep yourself busy with your mobile?
- Can't you control your mobile bills?
- Do you hate talking to people in person, but feel like chatting with them on mobile?

Becoming Human . . .

- Keep some mobile free time in a day
- Keep mobiles switched off when you sleep
- Keep distance from phone while talking
- Keep it away from you as much as possible
- Treat it as your slave, don't let it dictate terms as your master!
- Use wrist watch; calculators, memo pads to avoid frequent use.
- Keep your calls and messages transparent, it relieves you from bad stress!
- Never keep mobile in your hand while driving
- Try to find out addresses by maps and by asking people! (minimise GPS)

Mobile Etiquette



- Use face-to-face communication to the maximum extent possible
- Avoid texting, calling people on mobile who are in the same house
- Use mobile only when it is absolutely necessary!
- Don't call someone just to pass your time!
- Don't call someone on mobile to ask a trivial thing that can be cleared on a message.
- Don't hijack some's one time by calling them in their busy schedule
- Be empathetic: Avoid calling busy people as much as possible
- Don't use mobile call where a text message or e-mail can serve better purpose.

Mobile Etiquette . . .

- In business calls, identify the most suitable time first.
- Message and ask whether it is the right time to call.
- When you say you will take only two minutes; don't take 20 minutes or two hours!
- Use missed calls as reminders only if you are asked to do so.
- Don't give missed calls expecting the other person to call back and save your money!
- Keep important points written so that you don't call again and again.

Mobile Etiquette . . .



- In business meetings, your phone should be in silent mode or switched off!
- In interviews, exam halls, and other restricted areas, you should not carry your mobile phone. If required, it should be switched off!
- Don't attend to a call when you are in a face to face communication or a business meeting; if required, take permission.
- Caller tone, Ring tone: tells about you! Keep it decent and appropriate!
- Avoid talking aloud on phone in public places, buses, trains, flights, etc.
- Maintain eye contact with the person sitting before you!

Finally . . .

*Your cell phone has already replaced
your cameras, your calendar,
your alarm clock, your watch,
and your Walkman . . .
don't let it replace your family
and true friends!*

Ultimately . . .

*Let your mobile number
be on the top of
the favourite list
not on the top of
the blocked list!*

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Developing Soft Skills and Personality

Week 5
Module 3
Lecture 27

Technology & Communication

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**E-Mail
Principles**

Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



Influence of mobile on human personality
How mobile has deviated from its main intention:
saving time, help in emergency, distance connection,
keep human relations intact

Humans have become “Moborgs”: sleeping, playing
games, watching movies, using it for checking time,
calculation, address, etc

Mobile addiction/Nomophobia

Obsessive compulsive disorder

Get angry, tensed, depressed without mobile

Suggestions for become human: mobile free time,
keeping it away, treating it as a slave, not using it as a
substitute for watch, calculator, map, etc.

Mobile Etiquette: Avoid when face-to-face communication
is possible; be empathetic about other's time; use apt
caller/ring tone; use silent mode/switch off; use e-mail

“The greatest polluting element in the earth’s environment is the proliferation of electromagnetic fields. I consider that to be a far greater threat on a global scale than warming, or the increase of chemical elements in the environment.”

– *Dr. Robert Becker, two-time Nobel prize nominee*

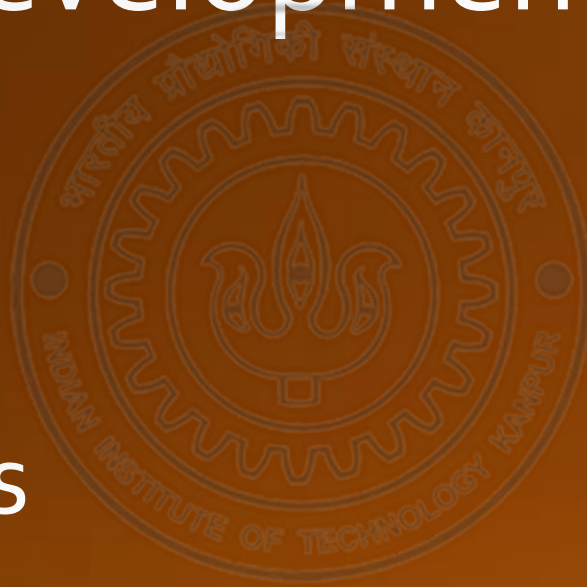


“Email, instant messaging, and cell phones give us fabulous communication ability, but because we live and work in our own little worlds, that communication is totally disorganized.”

– *Marilyn vos Savant*

5Ps/Cardinal Principles of Soft Skills and Personality Development

- Planning
- Preparedness
- Persuasiveness
- Presentability
- Perseverance



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An E-mail I received!

- respected sir
my name is **AMEET PRAKAASH**



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Analyse the following situations, identify what is lacking and what can be improved:

- Sanjay has come to the instructor's office to request for course registration. After some discussion, and putting some conditions about attendance and discipline, the instructor agrees to take him in the course. He asks Sanjay to write an application and get his approval. Sanjay looks at the papers kept in the instructor's printer and asks him: "Give me a paper." After the instructor gives Sanjay a paper, Sanjay asks him; "Give me a pen." The instructor says: "Get out of my room, and I will not permit you to join my course!"
- Why did the instructor, who accepted to take Sanjay in his course, refused to take him later? Is the instructor justified in doing so? Did Sanjay know the reason for the instructor's change in behaviour? Will Sanjay be able to avoid this situation in future?

Will the instructor approve of this request?

- Rohit was in a hurry to get the course approved. He was already late for registration.

He rushed to the instructor's office. He banged at the door. Then he barged in. There were some students sitting before the instructor. He pulled a chair on his own and sat. He put his application above other ones, and said: "Sign, I am in a hurry, I want to take this course."

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Will the instructor approve of this request?

- Manish and Harish gently knocked at the door of the instructor and politely asked, 'May we come in Sir'. Once the instructor said, "yes, come in," they went in saying "Thank you Sir." Impressed by their good manners, the instructor allowed them to take their seats. Again they thanked the instructor. When the instructor said what do you want? They humbly said that "Sir, we want to take your course and want your permission for it."
- Have you written the application?
- Yes Sir, please take a look, and approve of it.

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The instructor's response

- The instructor looked at it and got angry with them, despite their polite manners, he shouted at them and refused to sign on the letter.
- What went wrong?

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What went wrong?

- Instructor's Name: Prof. Rajasekar
- They wrote: Prof. Rajeshwari!

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Smart Students

- Chanku and Manku are smart students. They knew that the instructor is impressed with polite behaviour and that his name has to be written correctly. They wrote the name correctly.
- Still the instructor refused, why?

- They wrote the Course No:
CHM455
instead of ENG455!

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Can you improve the situation?

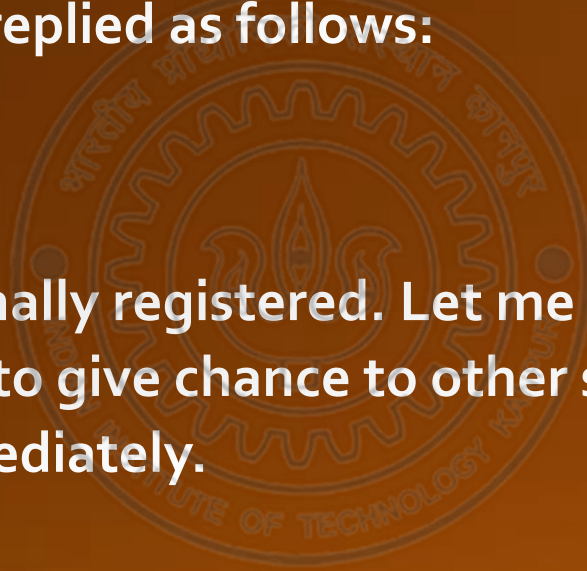
- With great difficulty some students got the course. Three of them dropped due to timetable clash. But none of them informed this to the instructor. When the instructor wrote to them, one of them replied as follows:
- Instructor's mail:

Dear Students:

Your names have not been finally registered. Let me know if you have dropped from the course. This will help me to give chance to other students in waiting.
Please inform by e-mail immediately.

Warm Wishes,
Ravichandran

- *Student's Response:*
- Yes Sir I have Dropeed The course
sorr for the inconvinience



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Compare A with B

A. Student's Response:

- Yes Sir I have Dropeed The course
sorr for the inconvinience

B. Student's Response:

Dear Sir,

I am very sorry for my delayed reply regarding the course dropping. I had applied for another course whose request was accepted very late and so I am dropping this course. I regret for any inconvenience caused.

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Kunal Kapoor
Roll No. 160076

Before you learn how to send E-mails,
it is important to unlearn your wrong
learning by knowing first—

How not to send E-mails!

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Week 5
Module 4
Lecture 28

Technology & Communication

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**How Not to Send E-
Mails!**

Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



5Ps/Cardinal Principles of Soft Skills and Personality Development:

Planning
Preparedness
Persuasiveness
Presentability
Perseverance

We looked at some E-mail examples which violate the
above principles!

Before you learn how to send E-mails,
it is important to unlearn your wrong
learning by knowing first—

How not to send E-mails!

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How not to send E-Mails!

“Hello Madam: I wanna go to my house. So, I gonna bunk your classes for the next two days. Give me two days leve, as I have to go out of stetion. Cheers! Shakshi.”

Bad E-mail
Examples!

“HI SIR: URGENT MATTER. VERY IMPORTANT. SUFFERING FROM SEVERE STOMACH PAIN. CANNOT COME TO WRITE THE EXAM. GIVE ME REEXAM. GIVE ME AN EASY QUESTION PAPER AS HEADACHE IS ALLOWING ME NOT TO FOCUS ON STUDY. LOTS OF LUV, ARJUN.”

How not to send E-Mails!

“Hello Madam: I wanna go to my house. So, I gonna bunk your classes for the next two days. Give me two days leve, as I have to go out of stetion. Cheers! Shakshi.”

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How not to send E-Mails!

- Good morning sir/mam,
i'm apoorva aladi from Bandwa(s.p.),
mene b.e(electrical & electronics engg) kiya hai Bandwa k SFIDDS
college se(2010).
mene 2011 me CAT exam diya tha jiska result abhi january2012 me aya
hai, mere CAT score card me total percentile 48 hai.,
me banking & financial mba karna chahti hu, mujhe janna tha ki kya
mujhe IIT KANPUR college me admission mil sakta hai part time mba karne
k lie?
If yes then mujhe please admission ki procedure batae, detail and fees
structure mujhe email kar send kijie. . . .

Thank you
apoorva aladi
Bandwa(s.p.)

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How not to send E-Mails!

- Good morning sir/mam,
i'm apoorva aladi from Bandwa(m.p.),
mene b.e(electrical & electronics engg) kiya hai Bandwa k SFIDDS
college se(2010).
mene 2011 me CAT exam diya tha jiska result abhi january2012 me aya
hai, mere CAT score card me total percentile 48 hai.,
me banking & financial mba karna chahti hu, mujhe janna tha ki kya
mujhe IIT KANPUR college me admission mil sakta hai part time mba karne
k lie?
If yes then mujhe please admission ki procedure batae, detail and fees
structure mujhe email kar send kijie. . . .

Thank you
apoorva aladi
Bandwa(s.p.)

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How not to send E-Mails!

To: <vinaygmit@gmail.com>;<spsinghaps@gmail.com>;<vchrgate@iitk.ac.in>;<aracad@iitk.ac.in>; <dosa@iitk.ac.in>;
<ardosa@iitk.ac.in>;<dofa@iitk.ac.in>;<ardofa@iitk.ac.in>;<dr@iitk.ac.in>;<sachan@iitk.ac.in>;<sandhya@iitk.ac.in>;<infocell@iitk.ac.in>;<kga@iitk.ac.in>;
<kamleshmishra1989@gmail.com>;<chrgate@iitk.ac.in>;<chrjee@iitk.ac.in>;
CC: <vchrjee@iitk.ac.in>; doaa@iitk.ac.in; dir@iitk.ac.in; dd@iitk.ac.in; faculty@iitk.ac.in; all@iitk.ac.in

Subject:Re:Re: Regardin Simmer Training in yr Institutionref:: dr. Satya Pal Singh, IITK, (assistant professor ,Physics)Now in MMM Gorakhpur

Main body (in text) of the e-mail:

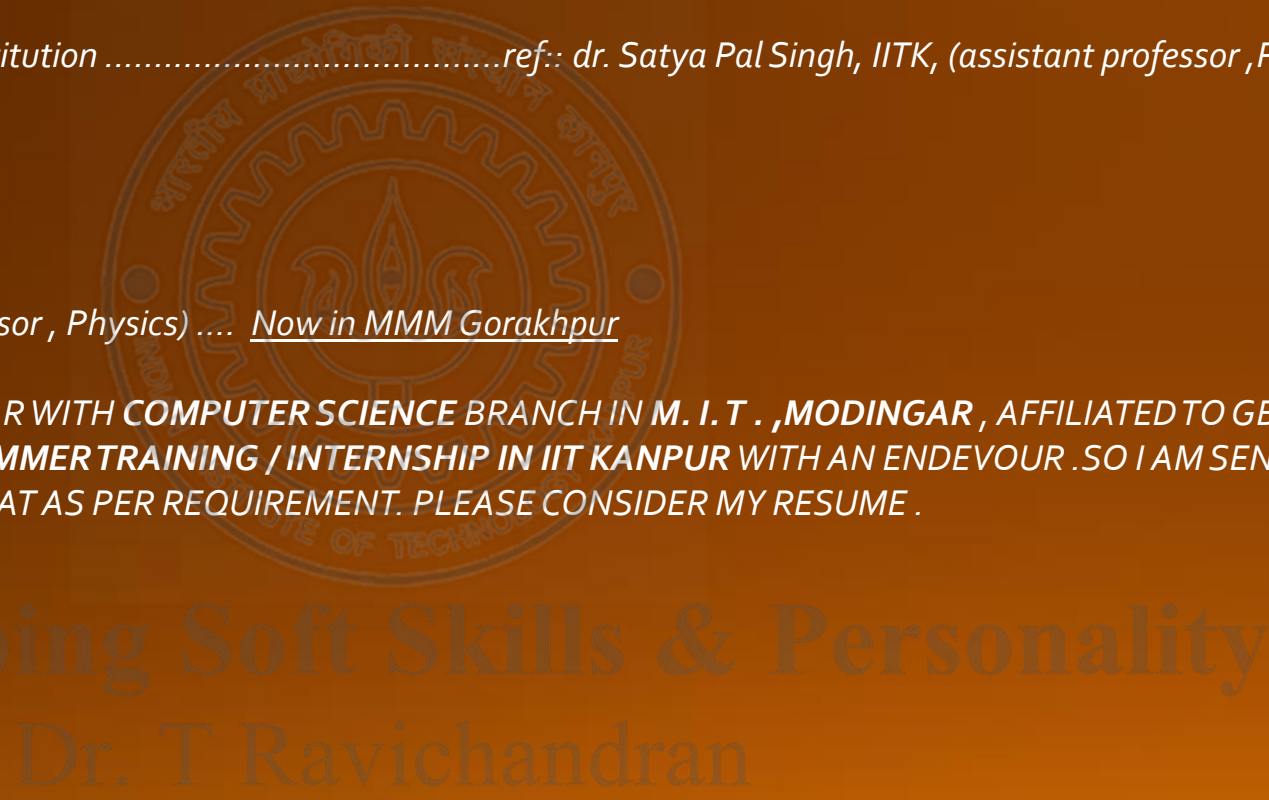
SIR/ MADAM, Dr. Vijay Pal Singh, IITK,
e-mail-- vpsinghaps@gmail.com (assistant professor , Physics) Now in MMM Gorakhpur

I ,AJAY KUMAR, PERSUING B.TECH IN THIRD YEAR WITH **COMPUTER SCIENCE** BRANCH IN **M. I. T . ,MODINGAR** , AFFILIATED TO GBTU ,LUCKNOW FORMERLY KNOWN AS UPTU .I WANT TO DO **SUMMER TRAINING / INTERNSHIP IN IIT KANPUR** WITH AN ENDEVOUR .SO I AM SENDING MY RESUME WITH THIS MAIL IN ATTACHMENT .CONSIDER THAT AS PER REQUIREMENT. PLEASE CONSIDER MY RESUME .

I WILL SEEING YOUR RESPONSE SOON

U MUST MESSAGE ME AT 9451145553

Luv to C U ON AJAYKUMAR.FACEBOOK.COM



Bad E-mail Examples!

How not to send E-Mails!

To: <vinay9mit@gmail.com>;<spsinghaps@gmail.com>;<vchrgate@iitk.ac.in>;<aracad@iitk.ac.in>; <dosa@iitk.ac.in>;
<ardosa@iitk.ac.in>;<dofa@iitk.ac.in>;<ardofa@iitk.ac.in>;<dr@iitk.ac.in>;<sachan@iitk.ac.in>;<sandhya@iitk.ac.in>;<infocell@iitk.ac.in>;<kga@iitk.ac.in>;
<kamleshmishra1989@gmail.com>;<chrgate@iitk.ac.in>;<chrjee@iitk.ac.in>;
CC: <vchrjee@iitk.ac.in>; doaa@iitk.ac.in; dir@iitk.ac.in; dd@iitk.ac.in; faculty@iitk.ac.in; all@iitk.ac.in

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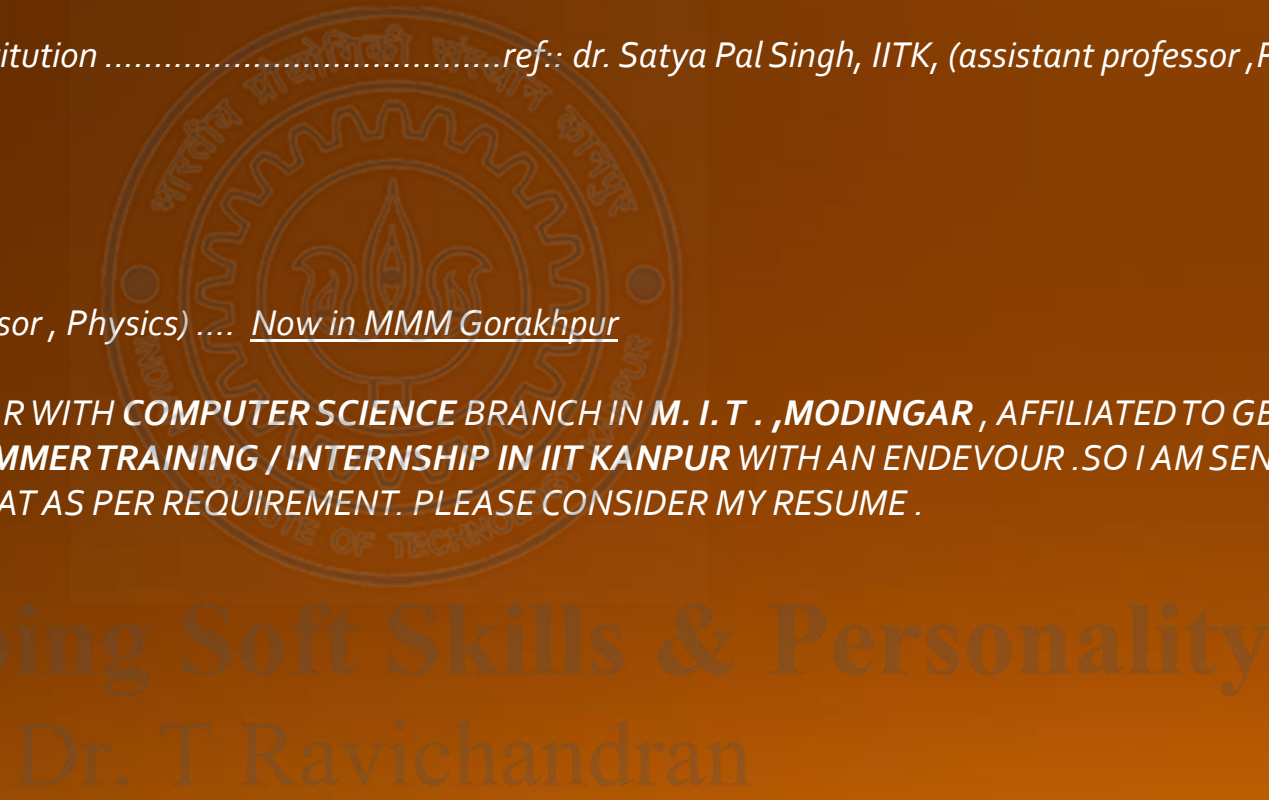
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I WILL SEEING YOUR RESPONSE SOON

U MUST MESSAGE ME AT 9451145553

Luv to C U ON AJAYKUMAR.FACEBOOK.COM



Bad E-mail Examples!

Conveying
bad news!

E-Mail sent to Students Group by a Student Leader:

Hi Guys & Gals:

It's so funny that our friend Shekar finally decided to propose to our college beauty queen Shilpa. Shilpa as usual rejected his proposal too! Poor fellow! Took it to heart! Drank a lot alone! Felt pain at night. Roommate took him to hospital. They refused. He was sent to a specialised hospital. Know what? Guys, he died on the way! Really felt sorry for this fellow yaar! Stupid guy! Don't drink tonight. Come for his funeral tomorrow! C U tom. . .

August 10, 2016

COMMUNIQUE

Conveying
bad news
properly!

With profound grief and regret, the University informs the sudden demise of Mr. Shekar Kumar Gupta (28417089) today afternoon.

Mr. Gupta was an M. A. student in the Literature Department. He reported to our dispensary at about 1.45 hrs with neck and chest pain for which requisite treatment and investigation was administered. However ECG revealed severe cardiac problem at an advanced stage and he was immediately referred to the specialized Cardiology Institute in the city. Unfortunately he expired before the doctors in that hospital could attend to him.

The sad news of his demise has been communicated to his family who are expected to arrive in the campus later tonight.

The University deeply mourns this untimely and most unfortunate death of one of its beloved students. We sincerely sympathize with the bereaved family and pray to the Almighty for eternal peace of the departed soul.

Vinod Mallik
Vice-Chancellor



"You should check your e-mails more often. I fired you over three weeks ago."

Developing Soft Skills and Personality



Week 5
Module 5
Lecture 29

Technology & Communication

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Netiquette



Highlights

Highlights of the Last Lecture



How not to send (bad) e-mails?

- ✓ Use of formal salutation
- ✓ Avoiding excessive use of capital letters
- ✓ Avoiding slang and colloquial language
- ✓ Avoiding mixing up of two languages
- ✓ Avoiding text language in formal communication
- ✓ Showing regard for punctuation, spelling and grammar
- ✓ Mailing only to the concerned person

***“The real danger is
not that computers will begin
to think like men,
but that men will begin
to think like computers.”***

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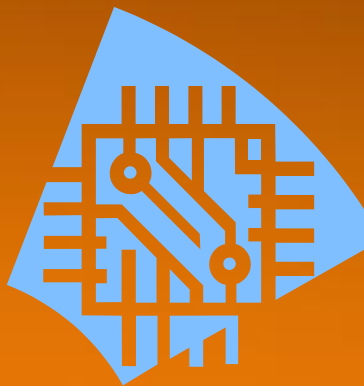
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~ Sydney J. Harris



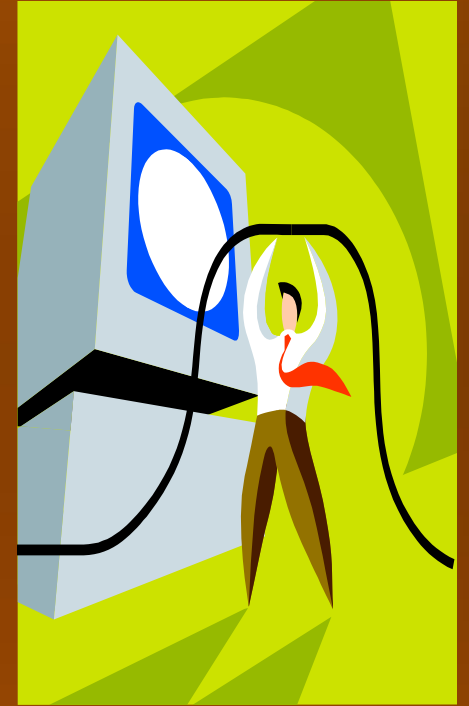
What is Netiquette?

- A portmanteau word combined from “Internet”/“network” and “etiquette.” Etiquette is an umbrella term for rules governing socially & culturally acceptable behavior.
- Netiquette thus refers to the correct, proper, polite, acceptable social, official, professional norms, behavioral patterns, and expected decorum for using the Internet or the cyberspace for communication purposes.
- Netiquette is about your code of conduct on the internet.



Why Netiquette?

- Internet has really contracted the world into a “global village” – but communication has become much more a complicated process!
- Despite the flow and exchange of information in various channels as Facebook, mailing lists, blogs, forums and chats, the question still remains whether communication is taking place in all these forms in an effective manner or not.



Why Netiquette?



- The Internet enlarges the vistas of human mind but has actually narrowed down values of the human heart!
- Increase in hate mails, sites violating privacy policies, hacking of e-mail identities, stealing of Facebook password, etc
- People misunderstand and lose precious relationships built for years by a casual click of “send” button.

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Why Netiquette?

- Sending emails has become the most used and abused form of cyber-communication.
- In the past, staff received training to write business letters and learn the nuances of sending effective letters.
- **However, no body receives any formal training for sending e-mails!**



Why Netiquette?



- E-mails are written without any **PLANNING** or **PREPARATION** and sent abruptly, without caring for **PRESENTABILITY**. Ignoring fully the human aspect of communication involved in the transaction process.
- The result invariably is miscommunication.
- This could be possibly avoided if people learn, understand, and follow simple norms for communication in cyberspace.



Basic Netiquette Norms

**Do Not Forget that the
Receiver
is a Human Being!**



Do not forget that the receiver is a human being

- Even when you sit and type on a blank screen, visualise the person at the other end.
- Type messages as if you are interacting with him/her face-to-face.
- When you will keep in mind the human element, you will not send curt messages that will hurt the receiver's sentiments.



Do not forget that the receiver is a human being

- Give human touch and personal appeal through suitable use of words, smileys and emoticons.
- Simple type keys as : -) can be used to create the following figures: ☺
- Such additions also tell the receiver how much care you take in communicating your message with the right tone and attitude.
- Consideration for others is thus, the cardinal netiquette principle one should always bear in mind.



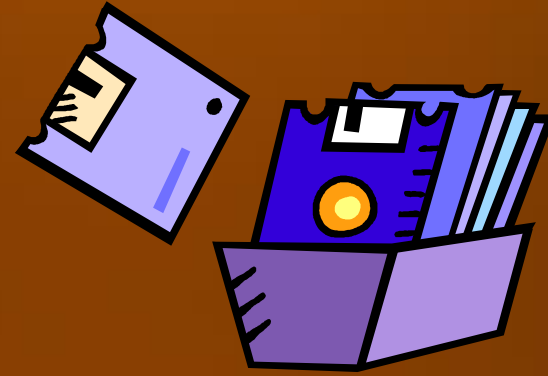
Basic Netiquette Norms

**Remember:
Written words
can be stored
permanently**

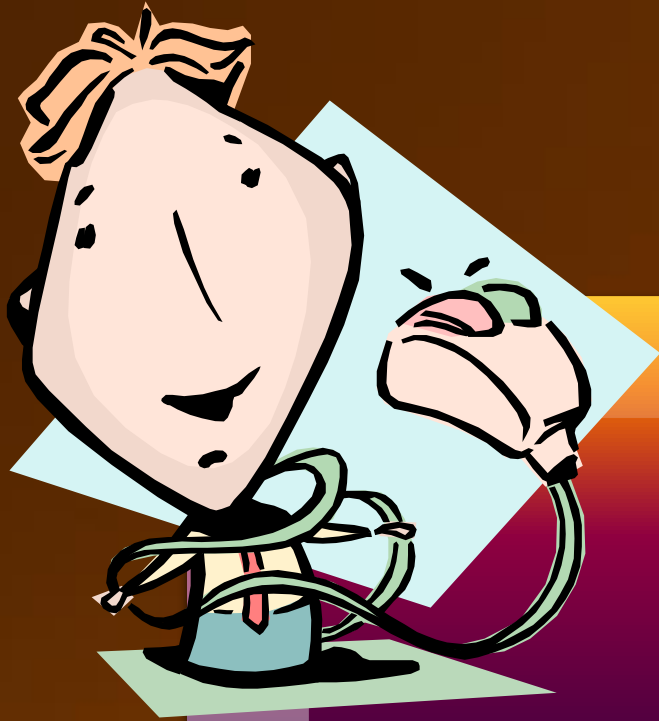


Remember: Written words can be stored permanently!

- Since written words can be stored permanently, one should be very careful in choosing the right words for communication.
- The e-mail sent casually can return with so much malignity that the sender regrets throughout his or her life for having sent that one thoughtless mail!



Basic Netiquette Norms



**Ironically,
the receiver controls
the sent e-mail!**



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Ironically, the receiver controls the sent e-mail!

- You have no control over your e-mails once you press the send button.
- Once sent, ironically, it is the receiver who has absolute control over your mails!
- The receiver decides, even if you have requested that the mail should be deleted immediately, whether to delete or store the mail for future use!



Ironically, the receiver controls the sent e-mail!

- The receiver also can use it against you, send it to numerous others, get a print out of it and post it on public notice boards and put you to shame.



So be careful about sending a message that would embarrass you if shared with others or exposed to the general public.



Basic Netiquette Norms



Be Ethically Correct!

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Be Ethically Correct!

- The old saying, “All is fair in love and war,” may be modified to suit the mindset of many internet users and as: “All is fair in love, war, and cyberspace.”
- Or, at least, that is what many net work users believe when they post materials which are unethical or communicate by lowering their ethical standards for the internet.



Be Ethically Correct!

- While unethical means may win short term gains, to gain a truly professional image one has to maintain high ethical standards in cyberspace too.
- Because of the risk of being caught in unethical practice is very high, and also the fact that, if caught, it can damage reputation gained for years, one should be ethically correct.



*Ethics is knowing the difference between what you have a right to do
and what is right to do.*

~ Potter Stewart



Developing Soft Skills and Personality

Week 5
Module 6
Lecture 30

Technology & Communication

*Dr. T. Ravichandran
Professor of English
Department of Humanities and Social Sciences
The Indian Institute of Technology, Kanpur, India*

**E-Mail
Etiquette**



Highlights



Highlights of the Last Lecture



Netiquette is polite and acceptable mannerisms for communicating with someone using the internet.

Why Netiquette?

People become insensitive while using computers

No formal training is given for using the internet and sending e-mails

The 5 Ps of Soft Skills are often ignored

SOME BASIC NETIQUETTE NORMS

The Receiver is human being; fully alive and kicking!

It's all about showing emotions, indicating you are not a robot by using emoticons and apt language.

Be careful in choosing right words since they can be stored permanently!

Receiver controls e-mails sent!

Be correct, ethically!

E-Mail Etiquette

**Make sense,
though it is
difficult to!**

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Make sense, though it is difficult to!

- It is easy to make no-sense in e-mails, especially when people type whatever comes to their mind without bothering to know whether what is expressed clearly reflects their thoughts.
- **Making sense is difficult—as it means curtailing some bad writing habit accumulated over a period of time.**



To Make Sense . . .

- **Plan your e-mail before hand**
- **Note down what you want to convey**
- **Prepare yourself by writing a rough draft**
- **Present it in a readable manner . . .**
- **Be Clear, Concise and Coherent . .**

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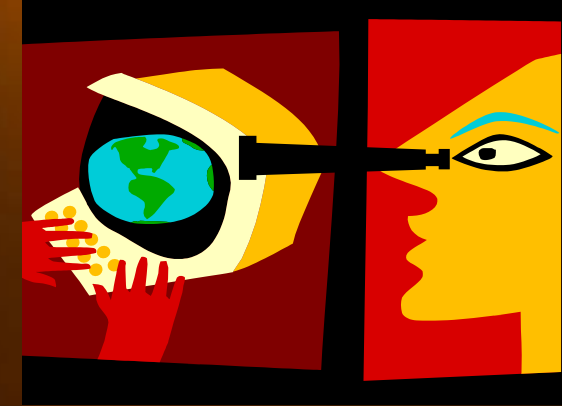
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Make sense, though it is difficult to!

- Avoid using worn-out phrases that does not make any sense in the context.
- Idiomatic expressions, metaphors and similes, if not used properly, may confuse the reader and lead to miscommunication.
- Use simple words with short sentence constructions
- Avoid flowery, poly-syllabic words, long and complicated sentences.



E-Mail Etiquette



**Spend an extra-minute
to save an hour
of the receiver!**

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Spend an extra-minute to save an hour of the receiver!



- Extra time should be spent on **editing the text, checking the spelling, inserting emoticons, making use of punctuation marks, dividing lengthy matter into readable paragraphs, remembering to type a descriptive subject line, and finally, by not sending an unsolicited and irrelevant mail!**
- Let us briefly look at each of these aspects in the following sub-headings.

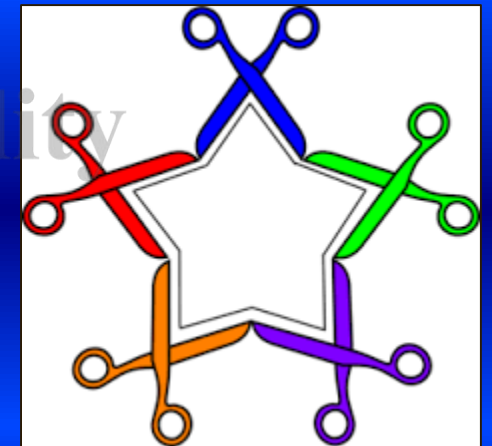
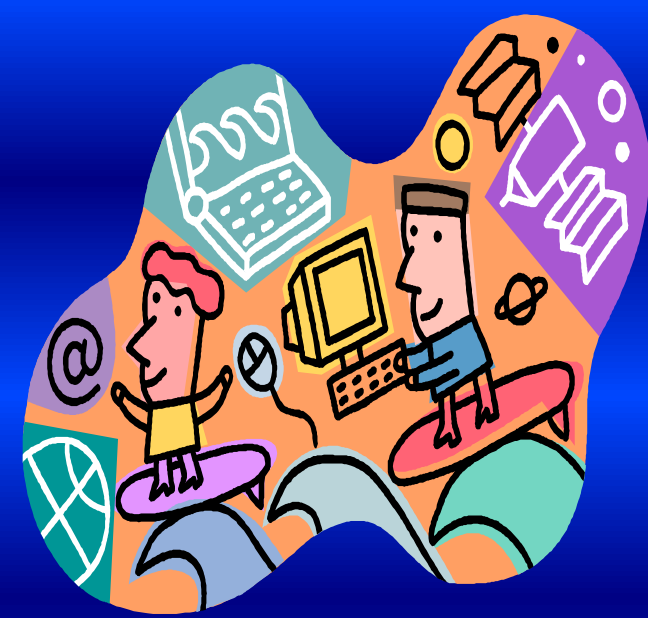
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E-Mail Etiquette

Keep it Short

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Keep it Short



- Keep your e-mails focused in content and short in length.
- People generally do not have time to read long mails.
- Some by default delete lengthy mails!

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Keep it Short

- If you cannot convey an idea effectively in a short paragraph you can never do the same in a long essay! Rule = 1 idea: 1 paragraph!
- In case an e-mail has to be significantly and justifiably lengthy owing to the nature of the subject matter, then **use subheadings, paragraph divisions, spaces in between paragraphs** to make it easy for reading and understanding.



E-MAIL ETIQUETTE



**Pay Attention to
Subject lines**

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Subject Lines

- *Tell me the subject lines that you keep sending, I can tell you who you are!*
- Subject lines, apart from describing the inner content of the matter, have much to tell about you as a person—whether you are sloppy, casual, flippant, uncouth, lazy or sincere, serious, meticulous, dedicated, professional, sophisticated and stylish.



Subject lines: NO SUBJECT!

- **The worst subject line that an e-mail can have is “[No Subject].”**
- **Because the e-mail is either sent in a hurry without subject line, or the subject is just not thought of!**
- **Indicates that the sender is unmindful of the precious time the receiver has to spend in opening, reading, and understanding the subject, and quite often realize that it is an irrelevant message that needs to be deleted.**



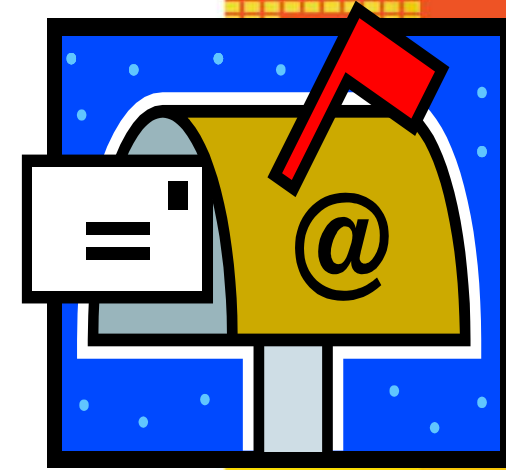
Subject Lines

- ✓ Should clearly express the content
- ✓ Should give freedom to the receiver to exercise an option of opening the mail or deleting it.
- × Should not use tempting subject lines like: “Free holiday trip to Goa”; “Open and become Bill Gates!”; “Stay young forever.”
- × Should not over-emphasize the subject by capitalizing them or by creating a false sense of urgency.



Subject Lines . . .

- Story: Manager's standard subject line:
"URGENT MATTER: RESPOND IMMEDIATELY."
Employees never responded!
- When you repeat the same subject matter it loses its sense of urgency and emphasis!

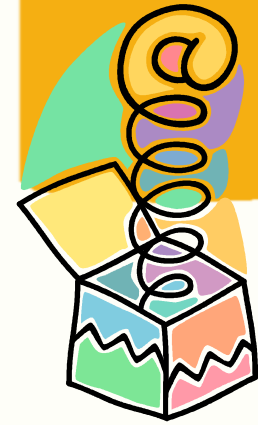


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Subject Lines . . .

- ✓ Use a short, descriptive phrase indicating the core idea of the e-mail.
- ✓ If it is a meeting, mention the time, date and venue in the subject line [e.g.: **Director's Meeting: 21 June 2016, 10 A. M., Conference Room-CR3**].
- ✓ If it is an e-mail invitation for a talk, you can mention the name of the speaker and the topic on the subject line [e.g.: **Talk on Cybernetics, Kevin Warwick, LH-16, 28 June 16, 4 P. M.**]
- *This will help the receiver to have a quick idea about the mail even without opening it!*



E-MAIL ETIQUETTE



Respect reply!

{Avoid:

Re:Re:Re:Re:Re:R

e:Re:Re:Re:Re:Re:

Re:Re:Re:Re:Re:}



Respect Reply!

- ✓ Use a subject line while replying a mail instead of leaving the automated “Re:” for reply.
- ✓ Example: An e-mail request for urgent loan, the employer’s reply with the subject line “**Re: Amount Sanctioned**” can be a great relief to the employee even before opening the mail!
- ✗ Do not use an old mail for the sake of address without changing the subject matter, which will be worse than sending the mail without any subject!



Respect Reply!



- As the Convener of the Department Postgraduate Committee, I received a mail from a colleague of mine with the subject matter: “Re: Vending Machine” but the mail requested me to forward a new PG course developed by the sender!
- Obviously, my colleague has used an earlier mail in which we had shared some suggestions on the Vending Machine, but to have that as a subject line for a course forwarding request is too inappropriate!



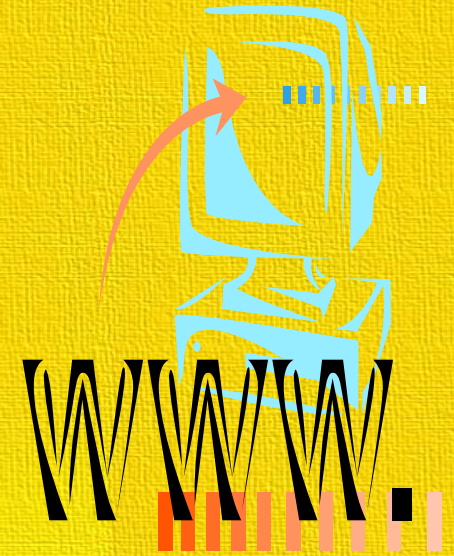
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E-MAIL ETIQUETTE

**Avoid Typing in
FULL CAPITALS!**

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Avoid typing in FULL CAPITALS

- Unnecessary use of capitals is considered SHOUTING or YELLING. MOREOVER, LONG SENTENCES WITH FULL CAPITAL LETTERS ARE DIFFICULT TO COMPREHEND AND EYES TAKE MORE TIME TO CAPTURE THE MESSAGE.
- You could see the difference just by reading the previous sentence itself!



E-MAIL ETIQUETTE



**No random CCing/
Do not Reply All**

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No random CCing/Do not Reply All

- ✗ Do Not Copy to many or reply all when the message seeks the attention of a single receiver.
- ✗ It is considered rude, bad-mannered, discourteous, and even uncouth because the sender is taking for granted the time of unsolicited receivers.
- Even just the time it takes to identify that the mail is unwarranted and then to delete it is unworthy.
- Hence, habitual or inadvertent copying to many or replying all should be avoided at all cost!



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E-MAIL ETIQUETTE



**Use
Abbreviations
Discretely**

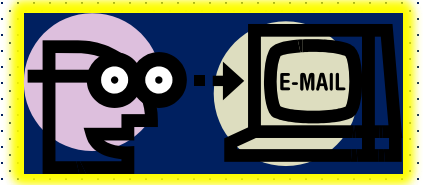
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Use of Abbreviations

- ✓ Use abbreviations or acronyms, which are commonly known and universally recognizable.
- ✓ AKA (also known as), ASAP (as soon as possible), BTW (by the way), CUL8R (see you later), FYI (for your information), KIT (keep in touch), LOL (laughing out loud), SYS (see you again), TYVM (thank you very much), WRT (with respect to).
- × Using abbreviations according to one's whims and fancy, and that too with inconsistent spellings would cause confusion to the receiver.
- × The message can be distorted or misrepresented and result in evoking a negative response.

E-MAIL ETIQUETTE



**Avoid
Spelling, Grammar
Mistakes &
Typographical
Errors**

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Spelling Mistakes/Typographical Errors

- ✓ Check your e-mail for spelling, grammar mistakes and typographical errors.
- ✓ Use in-built spell checker that underlines errors while typing itself.
- ✓ Pay attention to those underlined words, you will not only save plenty of the receiver's time but also ensure that your message is communicated effectively!

Bad spelling and frequent typographical errors reflect illiteracy and lack of professionalism!



E-MAIL ETIQUETTE

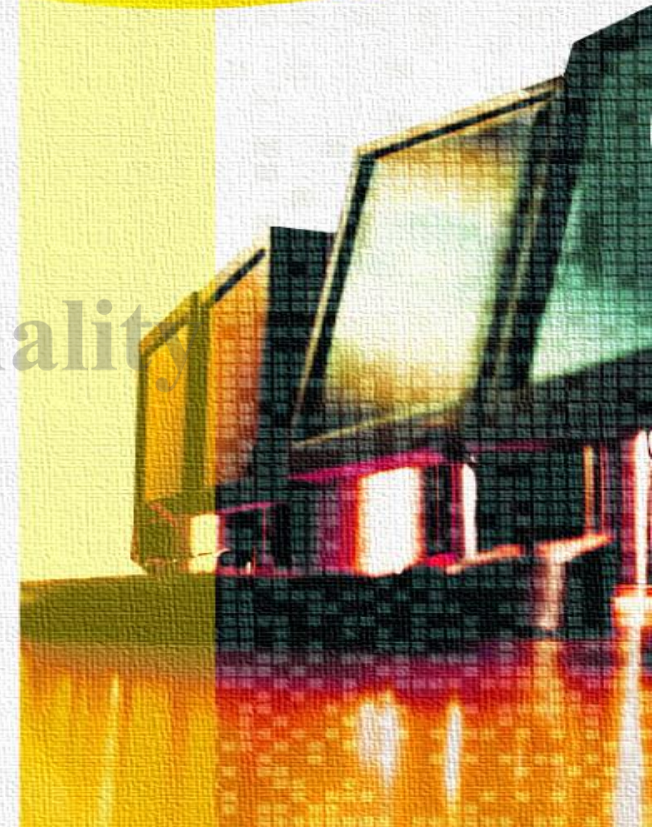


**Take Note of
Punctuation Marks!**

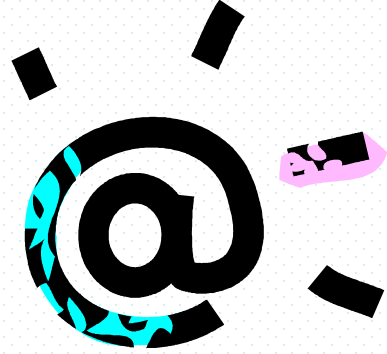
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Punctuation Marks

- Many wrongly think that punctuation marks are not necessary while sending e-mails.
- But punctuation marks, capitalization, and spaces after punctuation marks are very necessary for clear communication.
- *Have a look at the following mail that I received from a research scholar. You can note how the sender's scant regard for punctuation, capitalization, and rampant use of personal abbreviations have immensely affected the readability and effectiveness of the mail:*



Punctuation Marks?!



thanks for d suggestion sir

if u can give me some more suggestions so it l be
very kind from ur side

actually I m P.G wd 67% in lInd year n wd 62% as al
over i was doing ph.d under mrs. b. r. Agarwal, the
principal of sarawati devi college bt coz of d entrance
announcement in kanpur university i could nt get my
thesis registered n it was also coz of the busy schedule
of my guide so as per my per n ds situation wt should i
do kindly send ur suggestions I wil be obliged so
sorry for ani eror

E-MAIL ETIQUETTE



**Check Your
Computer Clock**





Check your computer clock

- **Set your system clock correctly (A.M. or P. M.)**
- **You will profusely confuse your reader during the fixing of an appointment for future while your mail would indicate a time lapsed in the past!**

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Conclusion

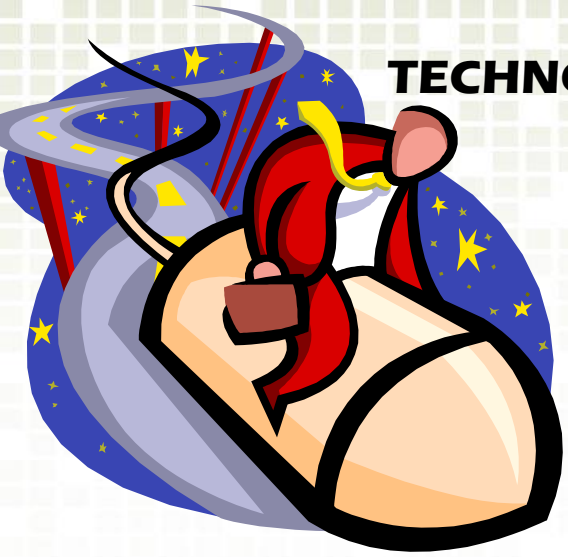


Netiquette norms, if followed, could generate a high level of professionalism and likeability and result in getting favorable responses in internet based communication.

Use this lecture as a quick check list for Netiquette and build up a reputation for sending good, engaging, thoughtful, time-saving, useful, effective and interesting E-Mails!

Dr. T Ravichandran

TECHNOLOGY AND COMMUNICATION!



And the moral . . .

Thanks to technology, we can

now waste time with an efficiency

until now unimaginable,

all in the name of saving time!



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